E2 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 5: Plans and the future – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to talk about plans with *going to*, say what they would like to do and why, and move between past, present and future in one conversation. Assessors listen for a range of tenses at Entry 2.

Materials: Handout E2-5A, one per learner. Twelve time cards for Activity 5, one set per group of three: *yesterday, last week, last night, two days ago, every day, on Mondays, usually, at the weekend, tomorrow, next week, tonight, next year*.

Activity 1: My week (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw a seven-day diary on the board starting from today. Write one plan in three of the days in note form: *dentist, friend, cinema*.
2. Say your plans in full: "On Tuesday I'm going to see the dentist." Ask what words you used. Board the pattern in boxes: *I'm / going to / verb*.
3. Drill with the three plans. Then let learners hear the natural, fast form, and tell them they will hear it from the assessor but should say the full form themselves.
4. Ask about the empty days: "What am I going to do on Wednesday?" Answer: "Nothing. I'm not going to go out. I'm going to stay at home." Board the negative.
5. Board the questions: *What are you going to do on…? Are you going to…?* with short answers *Yes, I am. No, I'm not.* Drill in open pairs across the room.

Activity 2: Your week (20 minutes)

1. Hand out E2-5A. Learners fill the diary in section A with real plans in note form. Tell them that ordinary plans are fine: shopping, class, cooking, phoning someone. They need at least four.
2. Pairs ask each other about each day and write the partner's plans in the second row.
3. Change partners. Learners now tell the new partner about the first partner's week: "On Friday Ali is going to cook for his friends."
4. Take one report from each pair. Correct *is going to* and *are going to* on the board.

Activity 3: I'd like to (20 minutes)

1. Write on the board: *I'm going to visit my friend* and *I'd like to visit Scotland*. Ask which one is a plan and which one is a wish. Establish: *going to* for a plan that is decided; *I'd like to* for something you hope for.
2. Drill *I'd like to* with the contracted sound.
3. Give three sentence starters and ask learners to finish them aloud, with *because*: "One day I'd like to learn…" "Next year I'd like to…" "In London I'd like to see…"
4. Learners write three true sentences in section B, then tell a partner. The partner asks "Why?" each time.

Activity 4: A talk about plans (30 minutes)

1. Board the frame from section C: *This weekend I'm going to… After that I'm going to… I'm not going to… One day I'd like to… because…*
2. Model a talk on *My plans for the weekend* for about a minute.
3. Learners make notes, single words only, for two minutes.
4. Pairs: A talks for one minute, B asks two questions with *going to*. Swap.
5. New partners, new topic: *My plans for next year*. No notes this time.
6. Two volunteers give their talk to the class. The class asks questions.

Activity 5: Three tenses (25 minutes)

1. Learners complete section D alone: sort the time words, then choose the correct verb form. Check as a class.
2. Groups of three with the time cards face down. A learner turns over a card and says a true sentence with that time. The next learner asks a question about it. Then the next learner takes a card.
3. After ten minutes, raise the challenge: the speaker takes two cards and must link them in one answer, for example *yesterday* and *tomorrow*.
4. Close with a quick mock of Task 1: pairs ask each other one question about the past, one about now and one about the future.

Answer key, Lesson 5

- **Section D sort:** Past: yesterday, last week, two days ago, last night. Now: every day, usually. Future: tomorrow, next week, tonight, next year.
- **Section D verbs:** 1 am going to go. 2 cooked. 3 are going to visit. 4 watched. 5 am going to start.